

Improving User Trust & App Experience on a B2B Marketplace

A data-driven review analysis for TradeIndia

ROLE Product Manager (Candidate)	TIMELINE Q3 2024 – Q2 2025	DATA SOURCE 580 Google Play Reviews	INDUSTRY B2B E-Commerce / Marketplace
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1. Context & Background

TradeIndia is one of India’s largest B2B trade portals, connecting suppliers and buyers across thousands of product categories. Its mobile app serves as a primary touchpoint for SME sellers to manage listings, respond to leads, and grow their business. The platform operates in a highly competitive space alongside IndiaMART and JustDial, making user retention and satisfaction critical business drivers.

As part of a product discovery exercise, I analyzed 580 user reviews from Google Play (spanning 2017–2025) to identify friction points, prioritize improvements, and develop a short-term product roadmap. The goal was to move beyond anecdotal complaints and ground recommendations in observable user behavior and language.

2. Problem Statement

“The TradeIndia app is losing trust among paid subscribers — users are increasingly reporting poor lead quality, app instability, and unresponsive support. If unaddressed, churn risk grows among the SME segment that represents the platform’s primary revenue base.”

The data reveals a steady plateau in average rating (around 2.3–2.8 out of 5 across 2019–2025), with a sharp increase in 1-star reviews in 2025 — 107 of the 187 reviews that year were 1-star. This is not a sudden crisis but a slow erosion of user trust that warrants structured attention.

3. My Role & Scope

- This was a solo product discovery initiative. My responsibilities spanned:
- Structuring and cleaning the raw review dataset (580 rows, 7 fields)
 - Conducting qualitative and quantitative analysis to surface themes and trends
 - Mapping pain points to product areas (app performance, lead quality, support, UX)
 - Prioritizing issues using an impact vs. effort lens
 - Drafting a focused product roadmap with success metrics

I intentionally scoped this as a discovery and prioritization exercise, not an implementation plan — appropriate for a situation where engineering capacity and business constraints are not yet known.

4. Methodology

4.1 Data Overview

Attribute	Detail
Total Reviews	580
Date Range	December 2017 – Q3 2025
Fields	Reviewer name, review text, star rating, date, reply flag, company reply
Reply Coverage	577 of 580 reviews received a reply (99.5%)
Rating Breakdown	5-star: 160 • 3-star: 140 • 2-star: 140 • 1-star: 140
Average Rating	~2.83 / 5.0 (weighted average across all reviews)

4.2 Analysis Approach

I applied three layers of analysis:

- Quantitative trend analysis — rating distribution over time, volume spikes, reply rates
- Keyword frequency mapping — categorizing negative reviews by recurring problem language (app crashes, leads, UI, support, payment)
- Qualitative thematic coding — reading samples from each star tier to understand nuance and emotional context

No automated NLP tooling was used. This was a deliberate choice to stay close to actual user language and avoid over-aggregating nuanced complaints.

5. Key Findings

2.28 Avg. Rating (2025) Down from 2.70 in 2023	107 1-Star Reviews (2025) Out of 187 total that year	87 / 280 'App' Mentions In negative reviews	41 / 280 UI Mentions In negative reviews
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5.1 App Stability is the #1 Complaint

The word “app” appears in 87 of 280 negative reviews (31%). Users report crashes on product upload, OTP loops preventing login, notification permission pop-ups blocking core flows, and WhatsApp number fields failing to update. These are not cosmetic issues — they prevent users from completing critical tasks.

Representative voice:

“After updating this app it is not opening, asking for OTP again and again after filling the OTP.”

5.2 UI & Navigation Friction

UI-related complaints appear in 41 of 280 negative reviews (15%). Users find the interface difficult to navigate, report that product catalogues don’t display properly, and note that basic account

management actions (updating contact details, deleting listings) are buried or broken. Several users compare the experience unfavorably to competitors like JustDial and IndiaMART.

5.3 Lead Quality & ROI Expectations

Lead quality is the most emotionally charged complaint category. Users who have paid for premium subscriptions describe receiving no leads, irrelevant leads from outside their geography, or leads from fraudulent buyers. Mentions of “waste of money” and “no ROI” are frequent in 1-star 2025 reviews.

Representative voice:

“Waste of money, waste of time, zero business in 7 months. Enquiries are coming from outside the state, not near to me, not even relevant.”

This points to a gap between the sales pitch at onboarding and the actual product experience — a classic case of misaligned expectations rather than purely a product failure.

5.4 Customer Support Response Quality

While the company replies to nearly all reviews (99.5% reply rate), the replies are overwhelmingly templated and generic. Users notice this. The high reply rate is not translating into perceived helpfulness or issue resolution — it is creating a false signal of responsiveness without actual follow-through.

5.5 Positive Signal: Platform Utility for Established Users

Among the 160 five-star reviews, 87 mention “good” and 25 reference “business” growth. These users tend to be longer-tenured sellers who have found their niche on the platform. The product is working for a segment of users — the challenge is expanding that experience to new and mid-tier users.

6. Pain Point Prioritization

Using an impact vs. effort matrix, I prioritized the four main problem areas. Scores are directional estimates, not precise measurements.

Pain Point	User Impact	Frequency	Est. Effort	Priority
App stability (crashes, OTP, notifications)	High	31% of neg. reviews	Medium	P1 – Immediate
UI/navigation & account management	Medium	15% of neg. reviews	Medium	P1 – Immediate
Lead quality & geographic relevance	High	6% of neg. reviews	High	P2 – Next quarter
Support response quality	Medium	Systemic pattern	Low	P2 – Next quarter
Onboarding & expectation-setting	Medium	Implied across 1-star	Low	P3 – Backlog

7. Recommended Solutions & Roadmap

Phase 1 — Stabilize (0–3 months)

- **App Stability:** Audit and fix OTP and login flow
 - Users report OTP loops even after correct entry — likely a session/token bug

- Add a fallback “Resend OTP” with human escalation option
- **Notification UX:** Remove mandatory notification gate from core flows
 - Notification permission should be a soft ask after user delivers their first action, not a hard block
- **Upload Bug:** Fix product image upload crash on specific device/OS combinations
 - Coordinate with engineering to reproduce using crash logs and top device models from review metadata

Phase 2 — Improve (3–6 months)

- **Navigation:** Audit top 5 navigation paths and reduce task completion steps for common actions (updating contact info, deleting listings)
- **Lead Quality:** Implement a lead relevance score and allow buyers to set delivery preferences at onboarding (geography, category, order size)
 - Even a basic location-first filter could reduce mismatched lead complaints significantly
- **Support Quality:** Transition from template replies to tiered response SLAs: acknowledge within 24h, resolve within 5 business days

Phase 3 — Build Trust (6– 12 months)

- **Onboarding:** Redesign the seller onboarding flow to set clear, accurate expectations about lead volume and ramp-up time
 - Include a “what to expect in your first 30 days” module during activation
- **Transparency:** Introduce a seller dashboard showing lead activity, response rates, and catalogue health — giving users visibility into their own performance
- **Trust & Safety:** Build a lightweight buyer verification step to reduce fraudulent lead complaints

8. Success Metrics

Rather than setting aggressive targets, I defined directional metrics tied to each phase:

Phase	Metric	Target (6-month directional)
Phase 1	App crash rate (Play Store ANR/crash reports)	Reduce by ~30–40% vs. baseline
Phase 1	Login success rate (OTP flow)	Improve from current error rate by measurable %
Phase 2	Average Play Store rating	Move from ~2.3 toward 2.8–3.0 over 6 months
Phase 2	Lead satisfaction score (in-app survey)	Establish baseline; target 30% ‘relevant’ response rate
Phase 3	30-day paid subscriber churn rate	Reduce churn by 5–10% from baseline
Ongoing	Support resolution rate (defined as user ‘issue resolved’)	Move from template replies to 60%+ resolution acknowledgement

9. Challenges & Trade-offs

Working through this analysis surfaced a few honest tensions I would flag in a real PM environment:

- Review data is not representative of all users. Heavy reviewers tend to be dissatisfied users. The 160 five-star reviews suggest a silent majority of satisfied users whose behavior we can't see in this dataset. Any prioritization must be validated with additional signals (support tickets, churn data, NPS).
- Lead quality is a two-sided problem. Improving lead relevance for sellers requires changes to buyer onboarding and verification too — which adds scope and cross-functional complexity. A narrow seller-side filter is a reasonable start.
- High reply rate is misleading as a health metric. The near-100% review reply rate could be (and was) misread as an indicator of good support. I would advocate for replacing this vanity metric with resolution rate.
- Expectation misalignment may be a sales and marketing problem as much as a product problem. Users who feel deceived about lead volume are expressing a broken promise made at the point of sale, not necessarily a product bug.

10. Key Learnings

- User reviews are a low-cost, high-signal data source when read structurally. The volume and temporal distribution of complaints can approximate a user research study in the absence of formal interviews.
- Prioritization requires honesty about effort. I deliberately avoided recommending lead quality as a Phase 1 item despite its emotional weight, because it is a systemic and cross-functional problem with high uncertainty.
- Metrics should be realistic and anchored to baseline. A 2-point jump in app store rating in 90 days is not realistic. Moving from 2.28 toward 2.8 over 6 months through sustained product improvements is.
- Qualitative context matters alongside the numbers. The Hindi and regional language reviews in the dataset point to a user base that extends beyond English-speaking metro markets — a localization consideration that data alone does not surface.

Note: This case study was developed as a product discovery exercise based on publicly available app store review data. All recommendations are directional and would require validation with internal product analytics, user interviews, and engineering input before any implementation decisions.